NeTrix

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Appendix

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Business name: NeTrix Limited Liability Company (LLC)
Business model: Adopting Micromarket Strategy in the early stage to establish long-term stable customer relationships by providing high-quality technical services. Subsequently charging for advanced information and carrying out partnerships to generate value-added service revenue and broaden sources of income.

1. Business Concept

NeTrix is an AI-assisted academic connection platform designed to make academic knowledge, expertise, and collaboration opportunities more discoverable within university communities. Unlike existing communication tools that primarily facilitate information exchange, NeTrix transforms student-generated academic contributions into persistent academic signals that help students identify relevant resources, discover knowledgeable peers, and build meaningful academic connections.

By linking content creation, academic identity, and peer recommendation into a single ecosystem, NeTrix aims to become the academic connection layer of the university environment.

2. Market Opportunity

Higher education is undergoing a significant shift as students increasingly rely on AI tools, private messaging platforms, and fragmented online communities for academic support. While these tools provide convenient access to information, they also disperse valuable knowledge, experience, and expertise across isolated channels.

As a result, students often struggle not because information is unavailable, but because academic content, peer expertise, and collaboration opportunities are difficult to discover beyond existing social circles. This challenge is particularly evident in university environments where knowledge sharing occurs across numerous disconnected platforms.

The growing reliance on AI-assisted learning further amplifies this issue by moving learning interactions into private conversations that generate little shared visibility. This creates an opportunity for a new form of academic infrastructure that connects academic content with student identity and peer discovery, enabling knowledge and expertise to become visible, searchable, and reusable across the university community.

3. Proposed Solution

NeTrix addresses this challenge through an academic signal network. Students contribute questions, learning resources, and experience-sharing content through the platform. These contributions generate academic signals that help build structured academic profiles reflecting interests, expertise, and learning experiences.

Using these signals, NeTrix provides AI-assisted recommendations that help students discover relevant peers, resources, and academic opportunities. As more content is created and more connections are formed, the platform continuously strengthens its academic network, improving the discoverability of knowledge and expertise across the community.

The platform's initial MVP focuses on validating this signal-generation mechanism among students in the Faculty of Science and Engineering at UNNC.

4. Business Model

NeTrix will initially operate as a free platform during the validation and growth stages to maximise user adoption and network development. Revenue generation will be introduced after meaningful user engagement and network value have been established.

Long-term revenue streams include corporate recruitment partnerships, precision advertising, career support services, and academic insight reports. Additional partnership opportunities may emerge through collaborations with educational organisations, academic service providers, and institutions seeking access to highly engaged student communities.

This phased monetisation approach allows the platform to prioritise user value and network formation before commercialisation.

5. Key Highlights

NeTrix addresses a growing academic information gap caused by fragmented communication channels and increasingly private AI-assisted learning.

Key strengths of the project include:

- A clearly identified student problem supported by exploratory survey findings.
- A differentiated platform that combines academic content, academic identity, and peer discovery within a single system.
- A focused MVP designed to validate academic signal generation and recommendation effectiveness.
- A scalable network-effect model where content creation strengthens profiles, profiles improve recommendations, and recommendations create new academic connections.
- Expansion potential beyond UNNC through cross-faculty, cross-campus, and eventually cross-university academic networks.

6. Development Roadmap

NeTrix will be developed through four sequential phases:

Phase 1: Prototype (May–June 2026)

Validate student willingness to contribute academic content and establish academic profiles through Q&A posts, resource sharing, and experience-sharing features.

Phase 2: MVP Pilot (July–September 2026)

Introduce academic signal extraction, peer recommendations, and connection requests to validate recommendation effectiveness and network formation.

Phase 3: Campus Expansion (October 2026–March 2027)

Expand beyond the initial user base, improve recommendation quality, strengthen reputation mechanisms, and increase cross-disciplinary interactions.

Phase 4: Network Development (2027 onwards)

Extend the platform beyond UNNC by enabling multi-university participation, opportunity discovery, project formation, and broader academic collaboration.

Through this phased approach, NeTrix aims to evolve from a university-specific academic networking platform into a scalable academic infrastructure that enhances knowledge discovery, peer learning, and academic collaboration across higher education institutions.

2. PROBLEM AND OPPORTUNITY

1. **Industry background** **what is happening in the market**

   AI is increasingly reshaping how university students access knowledge and academic support. Tools such as ChatGPT, Gemini, Kimi, and Coze are now commonly used for coursework assistance, concept explanation, resource discovery, and assignment preparation. As a result, learning is becoming more personalized, immediate, and individually driven.

   At the same time, students continue to rely on a diverse set of academic support channels, including official university platforms, private messaging groups, peer networks, shared resource folders, and AI tools. While these channels provide valuable support, they operate largely as separate systems rather than a coherent academic environment.

   This shift creates a new challenge for higher education. As more learning activities occur across fragmented and often private channels, academic knowledge, experience, and expertise become increasingly difficult to discover beyond existing social circles. Students may have access to more information than ever before, yet visibility into relevant peer knowledge, academic experience, and potential collaborators remains limited.

2. **Problem identification** **specific: who, where, when, why, how**

   Although students have access to more information than ever before, academic knowledge, experience, and expertise remain difficult to discover because they are scattered across isolated channels and disconnected from the people who possess them. Core

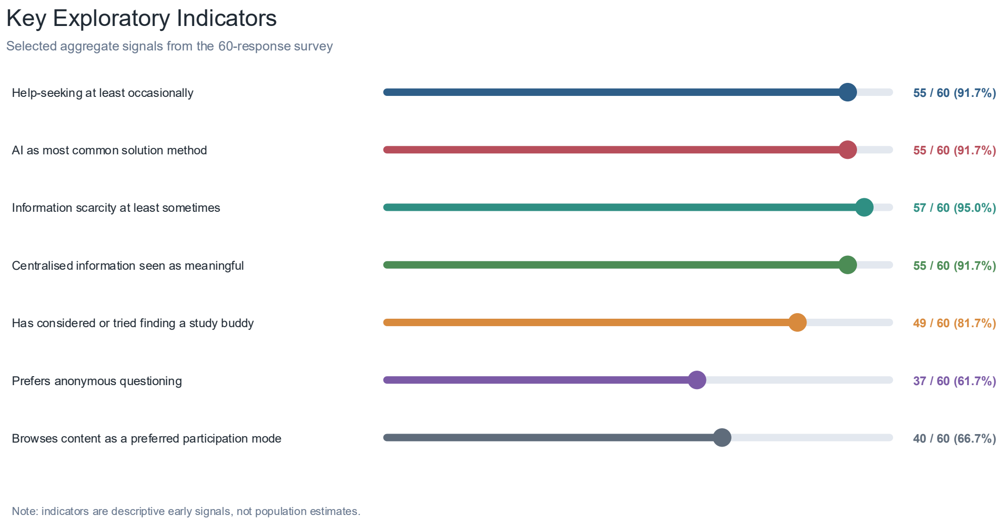
   The rise of AI-assisted learning further shifts learning activity into private interactions, reducing visibility into peer knowledge, experience, and collaboration opportunities. Deep

   This creates a new academic information gap: students may have more tools than before, but less shared visibility into the learning activity around them. They struggle not only to find information, but also to discover relevant academic peers.

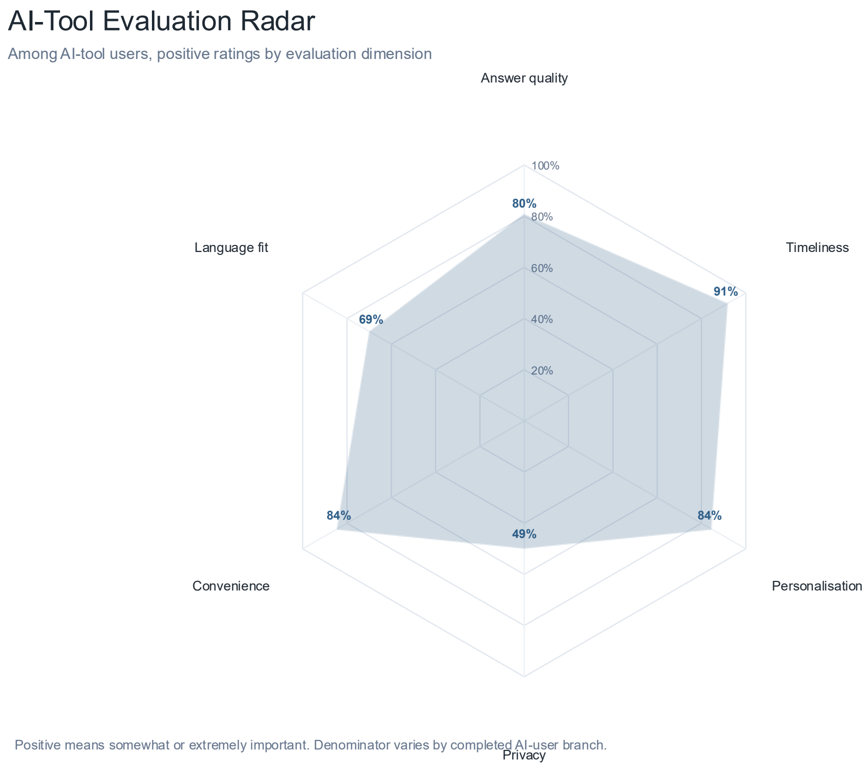
3. **Evidence of the problem** **our survey result, observations (we need interviews but we don't have), other research**

   An initial 60-response exploratory survey suggests that students frequently rely on AI tools, experience recurring academic information scarcity, and see value in centralized academic information. The data also indicates interest in academic opportunities, course advice, resource sharing, and study-buddy discovery. Because the sample is exploratory and not fully representative of the first MVP wedge, these findings should be treated as early discovery evidence and followed by targeted interviews and MVP behavioral testing.

   - Key indicators:
     The strongest aggregate signals are AI-tool reliance, recurring information scarcity, perceived value of centralized information, study-buddy interest, preference for anonymous questioning, and passive browsing tendency.



- AI tool evaluation
  Among respondents in the AI-user branch, timeliness, personalization, convenience, and answer quality are especially valued. Privacy is more divided than the other dimensions.



4. **Failed existing solutions** what currently do, why inefficient
   Students currently rely on a variety of tools and channels to support their academic activities, including WeChat groups, Moodle, Student Hub, shared resource folders, and AI chatbots. Each of these alternatives addresses a specific aspect of the student learning experience. For example, WeChat facilitates rapid communication, AI tools provide immediate academic

assistance, and resource repositories enable information storage and retrieval.

Alternative	Provides	Remaining gap
WeChat groups and private chats	Fast communication and peer interaction	Knowledge is difficult to search, preserve, and discover beyond existing social circles
Official school channels	Formal information and announcements	Limited peer-generated experience and student-to-student knowledge exchange
Resource folders	Storage and access to files	Little context about who created resources, who needs them, or how they relate to potential collaborators
Q&A forums	Question-and-answer discussions	Weak academic identity and limited support for discovering relevant peers
LinkedIn	Professional identity and networking	Not designed for module-level learning, coursework support, or campus academic collaboration
AI chatbots	Instant and personalized answers	Knowledge remains private and is rarely transformed into shared community learning

Despite their usefulness, these solutions operate largely as separate systems rather than a connected academic environment. Information, expertise, and opportunities for collaboration remain fragmented across different platforms, making them difficult to discover and reuse. As a result, students often struggle not because information is unavailable, but because academic content, student identity, peer discovery, and collaboration mechanisms are not integrated into a coherent network. This remaining gap represents the core opportunity explored by NeTrix.

5. Market opportunity what becomes possible if problem solved

The persistence of these challenges suggests an opportunity for new forms of academic infrastructure that make academic knowledge, experience, and peer expertise more visible and discoverable. If academic content, student identity, and collaboration opportunities can be connected more effectively, resource circulation, peer support, and academic networking within the university environment may be significantly improved. current

Beyond addressing immediate student needs, such an approach may also create a broader institutional opportunity. If a shared academic network can be successfully validated within UNNC, the model could potentially be adapted to other university contexts, support institutional partnerships, and contribute to the development of campus-level academic engagement infrastructure. Future-if we cale

3. CUSTOMER AND MARKET ANALYSIS

Target market:

The initial primary users are students from FoSE at the University of Nottingham Ningbo China (UNNC), and it will be expanded to all students at the UNNC. The secondary users consists of two parts. Firstly, there are on campus teaching staff, departmental leaders, and relevant academic collaborators. The second is the potential expansion group, such as students from other Sino foreign cooperative universities in the Yangtze River Delta in the future, as well as students from universities with cross school academic collaboration needs.

Customer segmentation:

Mainly divided into three sections based on colleges, which are FoSE, NUBS, and FOHS.

Customer personas:

- Q&A user

Core features: Students who need precise help when encountering complex knowledge points

Typical scenario: When rushing to complete tasks or preparing exams late at night, there is no response to questions asked through private channels, and private AI answers cannot meet the course requirements precisely

Core demand: Quickly find classmates who are in the same class or proficient in the knowledge point and receive targeted academic guidance

- Study buddy user (FoSE)

Core features: To discuss problems or participate in projects or competitions, it is necessary to seek collaborative partners with complementary skills

Typical scenario: A sophomore majoring in Statistics needs to discuss knowledge points with others, but cannot find an appropriate study buddy

Core demand: Quickly find learning partners who can discuss knowledge points and complement skills together, meet the collaborative needs of course discussions, project development, and competition teams, and break the dilemma of not being able to find suitable learning partners

- Resource aggregation user (NUBS)

Core features: Habitual organization of learning materials, while requiring access to high-quality review resources across grades/majors

Typical scenario: A sophomore majoring in FAM can obtain fragmented learning materials or experience sharing from various channels while reviewing professional courses, but lacks a systematic information integration platform to provide materials

Core demand: A unified resource storage and classification retrieval platform to achieve efficient exchange and precipitation of learning materials

Customer pain points and needs:

- Information fragmentation: Learning resources are scattered across various channels without unified storage and classification
- Information gap: The channels for obtaining resources vary greatly among different students
- Decreasing group leaning caused by AI: For students who need group learning, the emergence of private AI tools has reduced academic communication among classmates, leading to a weakened collaborative learning atmosphere on campus

Market size and growth potential:

Market size:

- TAM: The student population of all universities in China has a wide range of academic collaboration and resource sharing needs, which is the biggest market ceiling for long-term expansion of the project
- SAM: All students at the University of Nottingham Ningbo (UNNC) are the core market where products can be accurately reached and exclusive services can be provided
- SOM: Focusing on the student population of FoSE, as the core breakthrough point in the MVP pilot phase, to validate product demand and business models

Growth potential:

- User growth potential: From piloting in FoSE to covering the entire UNNC campus, gradually expanding the user base
- Revenue growth potential: From initial free cultivation to mid-term charging for value-added information, and long-term academic partnership and other diversified income
- Product growth potential:

4. COMPETITOR ANALYSIS

1. **Current alternatives** **anything partly solve the problem (wx, allink, miaojun…)**

Alternative	Primary Function	Role in Student Academic Life
WeChat groups and private chats	Messaging	Course communication and informal information sharing
Official school channels	Information dissemination	University announcements and administrative updates
Shared resource folders	Resource storage	Distribution of lecture notes and study materials
Moodle discussion forums	Academic discussion	Course-related Q&A and module interaction
LinkedIn	Professional networking	Career development and professional identity
AI chatbots	Information retrieval	Instant answers and academic assistance

2. **Competitor analysis** **matrix**

Criteria	WeChat	Allink	Moodle Forum	AI Chatbots	NeTrix
Resource discoverability	Low	Low	Medium	Low	High
Academic expertise visibility	Low	Low-Medium	Low	None	High
Expertise discoverability	Low	Medium	Low	None	High
Peer matching	Low	Medium	Low	None	High
Knowledge persistence	Low	Low	High	Low	High
Academic network building	Low	Medium	Low	None	High

3. **Gap analysis** **what remains unsolved**

Current alternatives enable communication, information storage, or networking independently. However, they generally treat academic contributions as isolated content rather than indicators of expertise. As a result, students can often access information, but struggle to identify who possesses relevant knowledge, experience, or academic interests. Valuable expertise therefore remains embedded within fragmented conversations and personal networks, making it difficult for students to identify knowledgeable peers, discover relevant experiences, or build meaningful academic connections beyond their immediate circles.

4. **Competitive opportunity** **our differentiation**

This creates an opportunity for a system that captures academic contributions as persistent and searchable indicators of expertise. Such a system would make academic knowledge, experience, and peer expertise more visible across the university community, enabling more efficient discovery of both information and relevant people.

NeTrix Mechanism

Academic signal infrastructure.
Students generate content.
Content creates signals.
Signals build identities.
Identities power recommendations.
Recommendations create connections.
Connections generate more content.
A self-reinforcing network.
Content → Signal → Profile → Recommendation → Connection

Differentiator

NeTrix transforms verified academic activity into a structured academic identity graph that can be used for expertise discovery and peer matching

Innovation

NeTrix creates a university-specific academic signal network where student contributions become discoverable indicators of expertise, enabling AI-assisted peer discovery and academic connection.

Thesis statement

NeTrix transforms academic contributions into persistent academic signals that power expertise discovery and peer connection.

Position

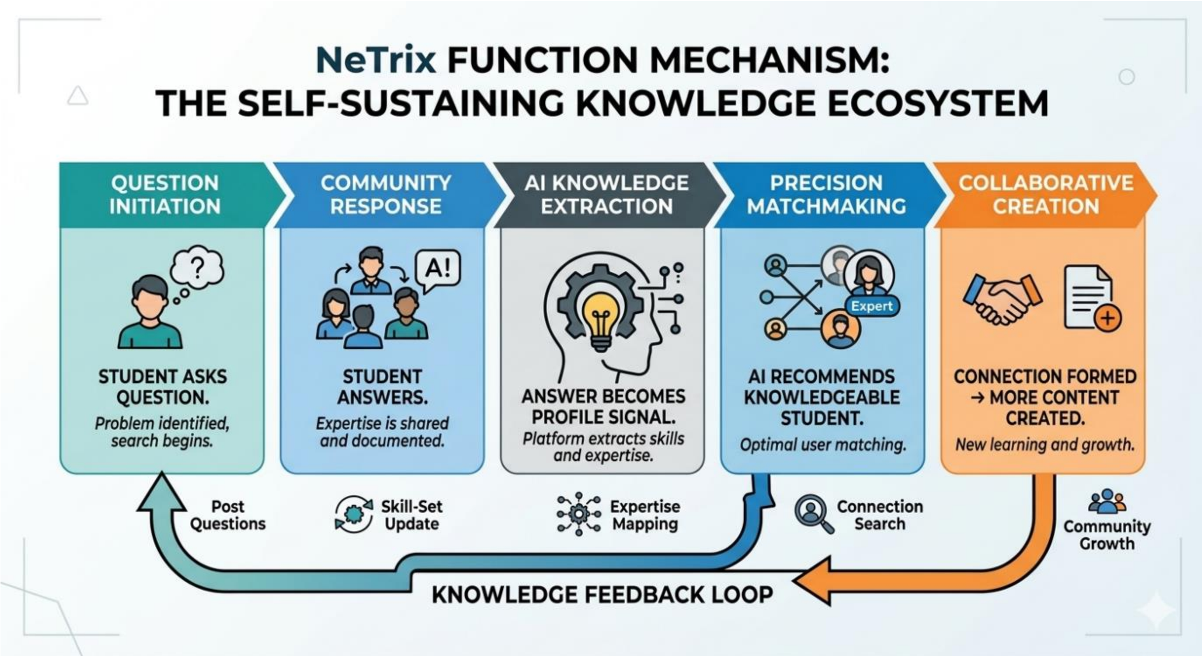
The academic connection layer of UNNC.
A platform that makes academic knowledge, expertise, and opportunities more discoverable.

5. SOLUTION AND PRODUCT STRATEGY

1. **Solution overview** sophisticated explanation

   NeTrix is an AI-assisted academic connection network for UNNC students. It responds to the growing academic information gap created by fragmented campus communication and private AI-assisted learning.

   Students contribute academic questions, resources, and experience-sharing posts. These contributions generate visible academic signals that form user profiles. NeTrix then uses these signals to recommend relevant peers and resources through explainable AI-assisted recommendations. As students connect and contribute further content, the platform continuously enriches its academic signal network, making knowledge, expertise, and opportunities increasingly discoverable.



2. **Value proposition** who receives what value

   NeTrix helps students discover relevant knowledge, identify knowledgeable peers, and build meaningful academic connections by transforming academic contributions into searchable profile signals and AI-assisted recommendations.

3. **MVP design** one of largest section

   - MVP objectives

   The MVP aims to validate whether student-generated academic content can be transformed into meaningful profile signals that improve resource discovery and peer matching.

   - Target users—undergraduates from EEE, Statistics, CS

   These disciplines were selected because students frequently exchange technical knowledge, resources, and problem-solving support, creating a high density of academic interactions suitable for testing the platform's signal-generation mechanism.

   - Core features

     Q&A posts

Resource posts
Experience-sharing posts
Academic profiles
AI recommendations
Connection requests

- User flow

Student asks question->Student answers->Answer becomes profile signal->AI recommends knowledgeable student->Connection formed->More content created

- Success metrics

	Number of posts created	Number of profiles completed	Recommendation click rate	Connection requests sent	Connection acceptance rate	Repeat usage rate
Stage 1						
Stage 2						
Stage 3						

4. User journey how user interact with the platform

Students create Q&A, Resource, and Experience Sharing posts. These posts help form editable academic profiles. NeTrix then uses AI-assisted recommendation to suggest relevant academic peers and explain why each connection may be useful. Students can request to connect, and messaging opens only after acceptance.

5. Future product roadmap evolution

Stage	Asset built	AI upgrades	Goal	Key upgrades	Output
1	Academic signal generation	Basic rule-based matching	Validate signal generation	Core loop: posts-profiles-recommendation-connection	First academic signals
2	Academic signal density	Signal-based recommendations	Increase signal density	More departments, better recommendation quality, more profile data	Design signal graph
3	Persistent academic identity	Explainable AI recommendations	Build persistent academic identities	Academic portfolios, contribution history, expertise tags, searchable academic records	Persistent academic identities
4	Cross-university signal network	Cross-university recommendations	Expand beyond UNNC	Cross-university verification, shared expertise discovery, inter-university recommendations	Multi-campus academic graph

5	Opportunity and collaboration ecosystem	Opportunity recommendations(teammates, competitions, research projects, internships)	Move beyond discovery	Project formation, study groups, research matching, team building	Academic collaboration ecosystem

Posts → Signals → Profiles → Discovery → Connections → Opportunities

6. BUSINESS MODEL

Revenue model

Provide free services during the MVP phase to verify that the platform's functions meet user needs and has a certain market share. A tiered-fee system will be implemented for advanced information subsequently to increase revenue by providing value-added services at different levels. When the platform has a certain user base and popularity, it can cooperate with institutions and academic communicators to further expand revenue channels. For instance, help a study abroad agency promote its projects or services, and charge a certain percentage of commission after completing the order.

Pricing logic

Mainly adopting a tiered-charging method, which means charging different prices for value-added services at different levels. Due to the fact that different users may have different needs, but it is impossible to comprehensively determine the specific needs of each user, this pricing model utilizes secondary price discrimination to segment the needs and allow individual users to make choices based on their own demand.

Cost structure

Key partnerships

UNNC has been a partner since the beginning. After the platform reaches a certain scale in the later stage, the main partners will expand to institutions or some academic communicators. For example, by collaborating with study-abroad agencies, NeTrix can help them promote their projects or services, which can also increase the visibility and revenue for NeTrix.

Network effects & scalability

Adopt a Micromarket Strategy, which targets a tiny market that comprises members who have already entered interactions. This allows the platform to provide effective matchmaking in the early stage. NeTrix utilizes this strategy, first targeting the pain points of students from FoSE at UNNC, and then expanding the platform's user base after ensuring that the service is effective and has a certain level of recognition.

7. GO-TO-MARKET STRATEGY

1. **Brand positioning** **how our platform is perceived by students**
   NeTrix is the academic connection layer of UNNC, designed to make academic knowledge, expertise, and opportunities more discoverable through academic signals and AI-assisted peer recommendations. Position
   The platform aims to provide a focused academic environment where students can share knowledge, build academic identities, and form meaningful learning connections. Brand personality

2. **User acquisition strategy** **how first users are obtained**
   - Phase 1: Seed Community

   We will initially recruit 30-50 students deom EEE, CS and Statistics through personal networks, classmates, student societies and seminar group chats.
   Goal: Generate the first academic content and test the signal-generation mechanism.
   Success indicator: 50 active users, 100 posts, 20 connections

   - Phase 2: Department Expansion

   The user group will expand into FHSS and NUBS.
   Goal: Increase signal diversity and test cross-disciplinary recommendations.
   Success indicator: 3 faculties represented, 200 posts

   - Phase 3: Campus Expansion

   The user group will expand to broader UNNC student communities.
   Goal: Validate whether the model works beyond technically-oriented disciplines.
   Success indicator: 500 active users, cross-faculty recommendations

3. **User retention strategy** **repeated needs, features, personalization, reputation**

	Ongoing academic needs	Profile growth	Better recommendations	Opportunity discovery	Reputation
Mechanism	Students ask questions, search for resources, seek advice, prepare for exams every semester	The contribution (posts) strengthens expertise signals, profile quality and visibility	More activity->more signals->better recommendations->more useful connections	New resources, experiences, competitions, and peer recommendations continue to emerge through platform activity	Make profile recognized by answering questions, uploading useful resources and sharing internship experiences

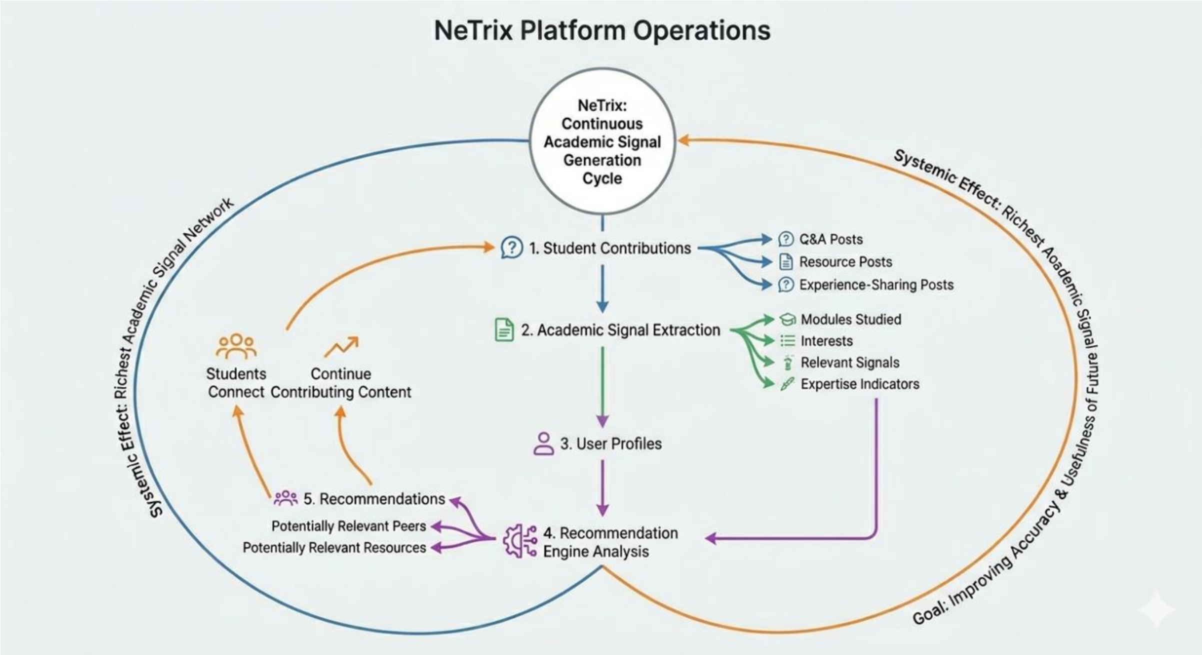
Explanation	Naturally occur needs	Investment in academic identity	A feedback loop	Chance indicator	Status created

4. **Community growth strategy from one faculty to more**
   Community growth will follow a density-before-scale approach. NeTrix will first establish a highly engaged academic community within EEE, CS, and Statistics to validate its signal-generation mechanism. Expansion will then proceed to additional faculties to test signal diversity and recommendation quality across disciplines, before scaling to a campus-wide network and eventually other universities. At each stage, growth will be evaluated not only through user numbers but also through content creation, profile development, recommendation engagement, and successful peer connections.

8. OPERATIONAL MODEL

1. **Platform operations** how the service runs/how user use

NeTrix operates through a continuous academic signal generation cycle. Students contribute Q&A posts, resource posts, and experience-sharing posts. The platform then extracts relevant academic signals such as modules studied, interests, and expertise indicators, which are reflected in user profiles. These signals are analysed by the recommendation engine to identify potentially relevant peers and resources. As students connect and continue contributing content, the academic signal network becomes richer, improving the accuracy and usefulness of future recommendations.



2. **Business operations** how business runs day-to-day

Functions	Objective	Activities
Community Management	Maintain user engagement and trust	Verification, onboarding, support, feedback
Content & Quality Assurance	Ensure platform relevance and quality	Moderation, spam prevention, recommendation monitoring
Product Development	Improve platform performance and user experience	Analytics, testing, feature prioritisation
Growth Operations	Support community expansion	Ambassador programmes, faculty outreach, partnership development

3. **Technology infrastructure** platform architecture

Layer	Technology	Purpose
Frontend	Next.js + Vercel	User interface and hosting
authentication	Supabase Auth	University account verification

Database	Supabase PostgreSQL	Storage of posts, profiles, and signals
AI Layer	OpenAI API	Recommendation generation
domain	Cloudflare	Domain management and security

4. Resource requirements hardware, techniques…

- Human resources

Role	Responsibility
Product Lead	Product direction and roadmap
Technical Lead	Frontend and backend development
Community Lead	User onboarding and feedback
Operations Lead	Moderation and administration

Growth phase

Additional roles may include: AI engineer, community manager, marketing coordinator

- Financial resources

Item	Estimated Cost
Domain	\$10–20/year
Vercel	\$0–20/month
Supabase	\$0–25/month
OpenAI API	\$1–20/month initially

5. Data governance and performance monitoring

- Data privacy and governance

As NeTrix collects user-generated academic content and profile information, responsible data governance is essential to maintaining user trust and ensuring regulatory compliance. The platform will verify use identities through university email authentication while allowing users to retain control over the visibility and content of their academic profiles. Connection requests will operate on a consent-based model, ensuring that communication occurs only after mutual acceptance. User data will be stored securely using cloud-based infrastructure and managed in accordance with applicable privacy regulations and university policies.

- KPI monitoring

Operational performance will be monitored through a set of key metrics aligned with the platform's core validation objectives.

Metrics	Elements
Content Generation Metrics	• Number of active users • Posts created per week • Resource, Q&A, and experience-sharing contributions
Profile Development Metrics	• Profile completion rate • Number of academic signals generated • User engagement with profiles
Recommendation Metrics	• Recommendation click-through rate • Recommendation acceptance rate

	• Number of successful peer matches
Community Growth Metrics	• User retention rate • Cross-faculty interactions • Connection request acceptance rate

These indicators will help assess whether NeTrix is successfully converting academic contributions into discoverable expertise and meaningful academic connections.

Metric	**3-Month Target**	**6-Month Target**	**12-Month Target**
Registered Users	500	1,500	3,000
DAU	100	400	800
Posts/Day	20	80	200
Matching Success Rate	30%	50%	60%
User Retention (7-day)	40%	50%	55%

9. DEVELOPMENT ROADMAP

Phase 1: Prototype (May–June 2026)

- Objective:
  Validate student willingness to contribute academic content and establish academic profiles.
- Key Features:
  • Q&A posts
  • Resource sharing posts
  • Experience-sharing posts
  • Basic academic profiles
- Success Metric:
  50–100 active users; At least 200–300 posts/resources

Phase 2: MVP Pilot (July–September 2026)

- Objective:
  Validate academic signal generation and recommendation effectiveness.
- Key Features:
  • Signal extraction from posts
  • Peer recommendation system
  • Connection requests
  • User feedback collection
- Success Metric:
  Students engage with recommendations and form meaningful connections.

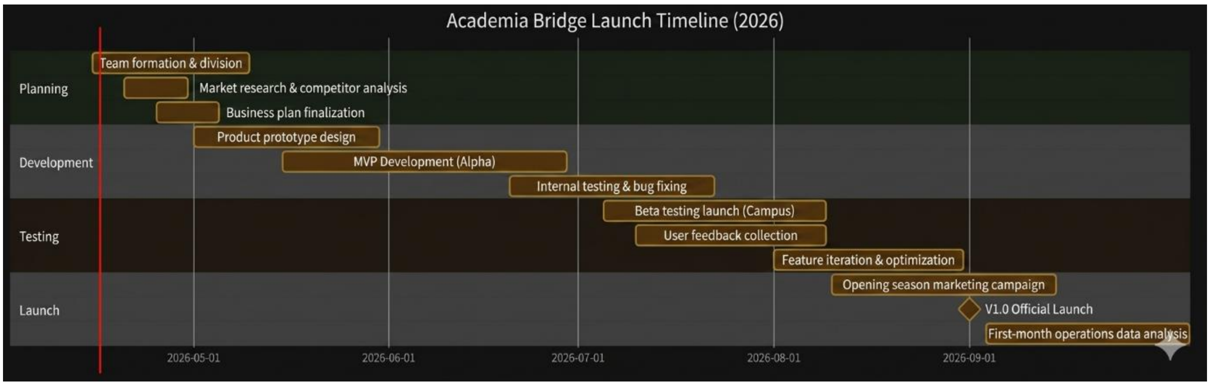
Phase 3: Campus Expansion (October 2026–March 2027)

- Objective:
  Improve recommendation quality and strengthen network effects across faculties.
- Key Features:
  • Enhanced recommendation algorithms
  • Profile refinement
  • Reputation indicators
  • Cross-disciplinary recommendations
- Success Metric:
  Growth in user retention and cross-faculty interactions.

Phase 4: Network Development (2027 onwards)

- Objective:
  Expand the academic signal network beyond UNNC.
- Key Features:
  • Multi-university participation
  • Opportunity recommendations
  • Project and collaboration discovery
- Success Metric:
  Successful operation of cross-institutional academic networks.

Phase	Strategic Objective	Key Deliverables	Success Criteria
Prototype (May–June 2026)	Validate student willingness to contribute academic content and establish academic profiles.	Q&A posts, resource sharing, experience-sharing posts, basic academic profiles.	50–100 active users and 200–300 academic contributions.
MVP Pilot (July–September 2026)	Validate academic signal generation and recommendation effectiveness.	Signal extraction, peer recommendations, connection requests, user feedback collection.	Users actively engage with recommendations and initial peer connections are formed.
Campus Expansion (October 2026–March 2027)	Improve recommendation quality and strengthen network effects across faculties.	Recommendation optimisation, profile refinement, reputation indicators, cross-disciplinary recommendations.	Increased retention rates, profile engagement, and cross-faculty interactions.
Network Development (2027 onwards)	Expand the academic signal network beyond UNNC.	Multi-university participation, opportunity discovery, project and collaboration recommendations.	Successful peer discovery and collaboration across multiple institutions.



10. MANAGEMENT TEAM

Organization structure: The project adopts a flat start-up team architecture, with a core management team of 5 people serving as Chief Executive Officer (CEO), Chief Technology Officer (CTO), Chief Operating Officer (COO), Chief Financial Officer (CFO), and CMO (Chief Marketing Officer).

Team introduction:

- Lingke HUANG | CEO/Product manager

Majoring in Statistics. With a core advantage in data modeling, data analysis capabilities can drive product optimization and user value enhancement.

- Zifan XU | CTO

Majoring in Electrical & Electronic Engineering. The core advantageis embedded development, which can ensure system stability and technological innovation.

- Yanghua XIA | COO

Majoring in Computer Science. The core advantage is full-stack development, which can optimize user experience and enhance retention and activity.

- Keyan HU | CFO

Majoring in Finance, Accounting and Management. The core advantage is financial analysis and cost control, which can help coordinate project financial planning and ensure the healthy operation of funds.

- Shuchang CHEN | CMO

Majoring in International Business. The core advantage is business planning and market expansion, which can help promote commecialization and revenue growth.

Roles and responsibilities:

- CEO: Develop overall project development strategy and product roadmap; Coordinate product requirement research, functional design, and iterative optimization; Coordinate resources from various departments to promote the implementation of project goals.
- CTO: Responsible for platform technology architecture design and core technology selection; Ensure system stability, data security, and performance optimization; Control the progress and risks of technology research and development, and provide technical support for product iteration.
- COO: Responsible for daily platform operation management and user growth strategy formulation; Maintain user ecology and content quality; Optimize product user experience, enhance user retention, activity, and reputation.
- CFO: Prepare project financial budget and cost accounting; Carry out cash flow management and financial statement preparation; Plan financing schemes and fund utilization plans; Control financial risks and ensure the healthy and sustainable operation of project funds.
- CMO: Develop marketing strategies and brand building plans; Expand user acquisition channels and business cooperation opportunities; Conduct market research and competitor analysis to optimize customer acquisition efficiency; Promote the commercialization of the project and achieve revenue growth and value realization.

11. RISK ASSESSMENT

1. Risk assessment matrix

Category	Risk	Potential Impact	Mitigation
Market	Insufficient student participation	Insufficient content generation reduces recommendation quality and network value	Begin with high-density communities, seed content, validate engagement before expansion
	Weak network effects	Users may not find sufficient value to remain active	Density-before-scale strategy and staged expansion
Product	Academic signals may not accurately represent expertise	Profiles and recommendations become less useful	Multiple signal sources, profile editing, continuous refinement
	Low-quality content	Declining content quality	Reputation indicators, community guidelines, moderation, recommendation weighting
	Poor recommendation quality	Reduced trust and engagement	Explainable recommendations, user feedback, iterative improvement
Financial	Revenue model may not be validated	Long-term sustainability becomes uncertain	Prioritize validation before monetization and explore partnership opportunities
	Infrastructure costs may increase	Operating expenses may exceed expectations	Cloud-based architecture and gradual scaling
Regulatory	Privacy and data protection concerns	Reduced user trust and compliance issues	User-controlled profiles, transparent privacy policies, consent-based interactions
	Platform misuse and inappropriate behaviour	Community quality may decline	Verification, moderation, reporting systems

2. Overall risk management approach

NeTrix adopts a phased validation approach to minimise uncertainty throughout development and expansion. Rather than pursuing rapid user growth immediately, the platform will focus on validating the key assumptions underlying its academic signal network, including content generation, signal quality, recommendation effectiveness, and peer connection formation. Expansion decisions will be guided by operational metrics and user feedback. This approach allows risks to be identified and addressed before significant resource commitments are made.

12. FINANCIAL VISIBILITY

1. **Key assumptions**

Variable	**Assumption**
Total UNNC students	9,000
Year 1 adoption rate	6%
Annual user growth	150%
Monthly active rate	60%
Corporate partnership fee	¥10,000/year

2. **Revenue forecast**

Revenue stream development

Revenue Source	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Sponsorship & Partnerships	-	✓	✓
Recruitment Services	-	Pilot	✓
Precision Advertising	-	Pilot	✓
Career Support Services	-	-	✓
Academic Insight Reports	-	-	Pilot

3-year revenue forecast

Year	**Users**	**Revenue (¥)**
Year 1	540	0
Year 2	1,350	50,000
Year 3	3,375	180,000

Revenue Sources:

- Corporate recruitment partnerships
- Career support services
- Academic insight reports

Revenue composition

Revenue Source	Annual Revenue (¥)
Corporate Recruitment Partnerships	80,000
Precision Advertising	50,000
Career Support Services	30,000
Academic Insight Reports	20,000
Total	180,000

3. **Cost Forecast**

Year 1 operating busget

Category	**Year 1 (¥)**
Hosting & API	18,000
Marketing	8,000

Testing & Operations	14,000
Total	40,000

3-year cost projection

Year	**Cost (¥)**
Year 1	40,000
Year 2	70,000
Year 3	120,000

4. **Break-even Analysis**

Year	**Revenue (¥)**	**Cost (¥)**	**Profit/Loss (¥)**
Year 1	0	40,000	-40,000
Year 2	50,000	70,000	-20,000
Year 3	180,000	120,000	60,000

NeTrix is expected to achieve operational break-even during Year 3 as user growth enables sustainable monetisation.

5. **Scenario analysis**

Scenario	**Year 3 Users**	**Year 3 Revenue (¥)**
Conservative	2,000	100,000
Expected	3,375	180,000
Optimistic	5,000	300,000

6. **Funding Requirement**

Item	**Amount (¥)**
Technology Development	25,000
Product Improvement	15,000
Marketing & User Acquisition	20,000
Legal & Administration	5,000
Working Capital	15,000
Total	80,000

The requested funding is expected to provide approximately 18–24 months of operational runway, allowing NeTrix to complete MVP validation, establish a sustainable user base, and begin pilot monetisation activities.

1. Research Gate

Official website

[Sign up - ResearchGate]

Fund information

[ResearchGate - Crunchbase Company Profile & Funding]

2. Academia.edu

Official website

Academia.edu - Find Research Papers, Topics, Researchers

3. Handshake
Official website
Handshake: the career network for the AI economy

4. Campuswire
Official website
Campuswire

5. Discord
Official website
Discord - Group Chat That's All Fun & Games

Assumption	**Year 1**
UNNC student population	9,000
Adoption rate	5%
Registered users	450
Monthly active rate	60%
Active users	270
Premium conversion rate	3%
Premium subscribers	8
Subscription fee	£3/month
Monthly hosting cost	£50
Marketing cost	£300

1. Bottom-up budgeting——cost
Website/app development
Hosting costs/year
Database cost/month
Beta testing
User recruitment
Marketing

2. User-Based Revenue Modelling——revenue
Users → Active Users → Paying Users → Revenue
Estimate users->estimate adoption->estimate active users->estimate premium conversion->calculate revenue

3. Revenue-cost=profit